

When competing grammars fight it to a stalemate: The verbalization of the infinitive in Hungarian¹

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In this paper, we analyze the appearance of the 1>2SG suffix on the infinitival paradigm in Modern Hungarian. This development is challenging for the existing accounts of verbal agreement in Hungarian because the 1>2SG suffix has originally been restricted to the finite paradigm. We argue that the full gamut empirical facts can be accounted for by recourse to three competing grammars for agreeing infinitives: N (where infinitivals are nominal), V_{deficient} (where infinitivals are verbal, with a paradigm gap in cell 1>2SG) and V_{full} (where infinitives are verbal, with no paradigm gap.) This results in there being two tribes of Modern Hungarian speakers: Tribe 1 (where N and V_{deficient} compete very discreetly) and Tribe 2 (where V_{full} is crowding N out). Grammar N is in line with É. Kiss's (2002) proposal; whereas Grammars V can be plausibly modelled in moderately revised versions of Den Dikken's (2004) and Bárány's (2017) system (both of which were originally developed with the finite paradigm in mind). Finally, we argue that the failure of the innovative paradigm (V_{full}) to spread fast and wide is due to three factors: (i) the relatively minor advantage offered by V_{full} to its alternatives, (ii) the fact that infinitival agreement in general is fading in the language and (iii) the spread of the Balkan subjunctive, which provides a more established outlet for the verbalization of subordination.

1. Introduction

In Hungarian, the finite verb agrees with the subject and with the object. Pronominal objects elicit either definite or indefinite agreement, depending on the relative position of the subject and the object on the animacy hierarchy 1SG > 1PL/2 > 3 (cf. É. Kiss 2013a a.o.). Infinitivals optionally agree with their subject (and do not agree with their object, if any), and the infinitival subject agreement marker is identical to the corresponding possessedness suffix (a suffix which indexes possessedness and the person and number of the possessor): because of this, most authors consider the infinitival paradigm to be nominal.

		finite verb (present tense)						infinitive	possessive edness suffix
		type of object							
		none	nominal		pronominal				
			INDEF	DEF	1	2	3		
nominal	SG	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-ja	-ja
	PL	-nak	-nak	-ják	-nak	-nak	-ják	-juk	-juk
pro- nominal	1SG	-k	-k	-m	-	-lak	-m	-m	-m
	2SG	-sz/-l	-sz/-l	-d	-sz/-l	-	-d	-d	-d
	3SG	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-ja	-ja
	1PL	-unk	-unk	-juk	-	-unk	-juk	-unk	-unk
	2PL	-tok	-tok	játok	-tok	-	-játok	-tok	-tok
	3PL	-nak	-nak	-ják	-nak	-nak	-ják	-juk	-juk

Table 1

¹ I would like to thank the participants of the following conferences for their generous feedback: the 17th International Conference on the Structure of Hungarian (ICSH17) in Debrecen, the 27th Diachronic Generative Syntax Conference (DiGS27) in Padova, and the 59th Annual Meeting of the Societas Linguistica Europaea (SLE59) in Osnabrück. The research reported here has been supported by Grant No. 101109402 (Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions), and Grant No. 129921 (National Research, Development and Innovation Office of Hungary).

Within this system, *-lak* 1SG>2 has long been a subject of intense debate, as it does not obviously fit either the definite or the indefinite paradigm. Many authors have treated it as something of an irregular form (Bartos 1999, 2001, É. Kiss 2002, Coppock és Wechsler 2012, Coppock 2013), while others regard it as part of the definite paradigm (Velcsóvné 1974, Havas 2004, Honti 2020). Bárány (2015, 2017) in turn regards *-lak* 1SG>2 as the only fully regular form, and all the other suffixes as deficient. Additionally, many authors assume that *-lak* 1SG>2 can be broken down into *-l-* (expressing 2 object agreement) and *-k-* (expressing 1SG subject agreement) (E. Abaffy 1991, Bartos 1999, den Dikken 2006, É. Kiss 2013a, É. Kiss 2017, Havas 2004, Honti 2020, Hegedűs 2020). The categorial status of *-lak* 1SG>2 is also debated: while most authors analyze it as an agreement suffix, Den Dikken (2004) argues that the *-l-* part of *-lak* is in fact a clitic which expones the object itself (in this framework, overt pronominal or nominal objects are analysed as adjuncts coreferential with the clitic). The empirical focus of my talk is the appearance of the verbal *-lak* suffix on infinitivals instead of the expected *-m* suffix (1c).

Consider:

- (1) a. *Be kell vin-n-em téged a kórház-ba.* infinitive
 PRT must take-INF-1SG you.ACC the hospital.ILL
- b. *Be kell, (bogy) vi-gye-lek (téged) a kórház-ba.* Balkan subjunctive
 PRT must that take-SUBJ-1SG>2 you.ACC the hospital.ILL
- c. %*Be kell vin-n-elek (téged) a kórház-ba.* the focus of our paper
 PRT must take-INF-1SG>2 you.ACC the hospital.ILL
- ‘I have to take you to the hospital.’

Infinitival subordination (1a) is the oldest and most established strategy; the Balkan subjunctive (1b) is a more recent, ongoing development in diachronic terms (É. Kiss 2022). While many speakers of Hungarian find (1c) marked, one can easily find hundreds of attestations in various corpora (Hungarian National Corpus, Hungarian Historical Corpus, Google Books, HPLT). It is also not a recent development: mentioned as early as 1645 in the grammar of Geleji Katona (1645), it is amply attested from the early 19th century onward. Academic linguists have also noted and described this phenomenon, without, providing much of an analysis (Simonyi 1888, Zolnai 1889, Horger 1900, Klemm 1925, Horger 1931).

The consensus in the literature has so far been that the infinitival paradigm is purely nominal, as evidenced by the (surface) identity of the set of infinitival agreement markers and possessor-referencing possessedness suffixes (see Table 1 above). Based on new syntactic evidence, I will argue that this view is incorrect: the infinitival paradigm does exhibit behaviour strongly indicative of it being verbal. Following Bárány 2017, I adopt object pronoun drop as a test of verbal agreement, and find that with the exception of *-m* qua exponent of 1SG>2, object pronoun drop is completely grammatical in infinitivals (I focus on SG objects, as pro-drop with PL subjects is a less reliable test in general):

	1SG			2SG			3SG		
1SG	-			<i>be kell</i> PRT must	<i>vin-n-em</i> take-INF-1SG	<i>*(téged)</i> you	<i>be kell</i> PRT must	<i>vin-n-em</i> take-INF-1SG	<i>(őt)</i> her
				<i>be kell</i> PRT must	<i>vin-n-elek</i> take-INF-1SG>2	<i>(téged)</i> you			
2SG	<i>be kell</i> PRT must	<i>vin-n-ed</i> take-INF-2SG	<i>(engem)</i> me	-			<i>be kell</i> PRT must	<i>vin-n-ed</i> take-INF-2SG	<i>(őt)</i> her
3SG	<i>be kell</i> PRT must	<i>vin-ni-e</i> take-INF-3SG	<i>(engem)</i> me	<i>be kell</i> PRT must	<i>vin-ni-e</i> take-INF-3SG	<i>(téged)</i> you	<i>be kell</i> PRT must	<i>vin-ni-e</i> take-INF-3SG	<i>(őt)</i> her

Table 2

I will argue that this pattern reveals a synchronic situation of two competing grammars: “Grammar N” where the infinitival is nominal and “Grammar V” where it is verbal. I will further argue that Grammar V is the more recent development, in line with the cross-linguistically well-known general drift of subordinate structures from nominal/non-finite to verbal/finite. Crucially, because of the near-total overlap between the finite and non-finite agreement marker inventories (see table above), nothing in particular marked out the infinitival paradigm as clearly nominal, which enabled the emergence of competing grammars by stealth. With the exception of 1>2SG, where the choice of *-m* clearly marks out the infinitival paradigm as nominal (and hence, object pronoun drop is not allowed here), Grammar N and Grammar V produces surface-identical outputs: the same output can pass as nominal as well as verbal. Thus, these two grammars can easily and peacefully coexist as competing grammars for an extended time (Kroch 1989) (cf. also Alberti 2020 and Farkas 2020 on the mixed verbal and nominal properties of infinitivals). I will further argue that Grammar V comes in two varieties: $V_{\text{deficient}}$, which has a paradigm gap in cell 1SG>2, and the more innovative V_{full} , which has no paradigm gap (having borrowed the *-lak* 1SG>2 from the finite paradigm).

I will also show that verbal agreement on the infinitival paradigm (both $V_{\text{deficient}}$ and V_{full}) can be plausibly accommodated in both of the two most influential current models of Hungarian verbal agreement (both originally developed for the finite paradigm): Bárány 2017, where *-lak* is a portmanteau morpheme spelling out 1SG subject agreement and 2 object agreement; and Den Dikken 2004, where *-l* is an object clitic and *-k* is a 1SG subject agreement suffix. While both models need to be revised and/or augmented in order to account for infinitivals as well, the necessary revisions are in line with the architecture of the original models.

In light of the general tendency of drift from nominal/non-finite to verbal/finite subordination (also attested specifically within the Balkan Sprachbund and in Hungarian, cf. É. Kiss 2022), it might seem paradoxical that the verbalization of the infinitival in Hungarian (as measured by the relative frequency of *-lak* 1SG>2 vs. *-m* 1SG on infinitivals in case of 1SG>2 scenarios) has been very slow: indeed, instead of Grammar V crowding out Grammar N following the well-established logistic curve, the relative frequency seems to be stable, with *-lak* 1SG>2 remaining markedly less frequent. I will argue that this is due to three factors. Firstly, the infinitival paradigm as a whole is being rapidly eclipsed by the Balkan subjunctive in Hungarian: this means that the urge to verbalize subordination already has an established outlet. Secondly, since the outputs of the two competing grammars are surface-identical except one cell in the paradigm, the competition is not intense, making the peaceful coexistence of the two grammars possible. And thirdly, agreement on infinitivals in Hungarian is optional in most settings, which further helps to mask any output difference between the two grammars.

The paper is organized as follows: Section 2 presents the patterns of the verbal agreement paradigm in Hungarian. In Section 3, the empirical contours of the innovation (the appearance of the 1SG>2

suffix *-lak* in the finite paradigm) are outlined. Section 4 reviews the relevant theoretical literature. Section 5 offers a critical reassessment of the analysis of agreeing infinitives. In Section 6, a competing grammars account is proposed. Section 7 includes detailed and concrete implementations of the competing nominal and verbal grammars of infinitives. Section 8 concludes the paper.

2. The verbal agreement paradigm in Hungarian

In this section, I present the basics of the morphology of verbal agreement in Hungarian. Hungarian is subject to vowel harmony: for ease of exposition, in the tables below, I only show the back-vowel forms of each suffix. Also, at this point, I keep the discussion theory-neutral and remain agnostic as to whether any of these forms can be decomposed into smaller units (e.g. a separate subject agreement marker and a separate object agreement marker). For the time being, I use the term suffix in a neutral sense, remaining agnostic as to these markers are indeed suffixes or rather copulas *strictu sensu*.

Descriptively speaking, verbs in Hungarian exhibit subject agreement as well as object agreement. Subject agreement indexes the phi-features of the subject (person and number), whereas object agreement indexes the definiteness/indefiniteness (and the presence or absence) of the object. Thus, in terms of object agreement, there exist two paradigms: the so-called indefinite paradigm (triggered in case of an indefinite object or in the absence of an object) and the definite paradigm (triggered in case of a definite object). Pronominal objects elicit either definite or indefinite agreement, depending on the relative position of the subject and the object on the animacy hierarchy 1SG > 1PL/2 > 3 (cf. É. Kiss 2013a a.o.).

		finite verb (present tense)						infinitive
		type of object						
		none	nominal		pronominal			
			indefinite	definite	1	2	3	
no min al	SG	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-ja</i>	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-ja</i>	<i>-ja</i>
	PL	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-ják</i>	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-ják</i>	<i>-juk</i>
pro no min al	1SG	<i>-k</i>	<i>-k</i>	<i>-m</i>	-	<i>-lak</i>	<i>-m</i>	<i>-m</i>
	2SG	<i>-sz / -l</i>	<i>-sz / -l</i>	<i>-d</i>	<i>-sz / -l</i>	-	<i>-d</i>	<i>-d</i>
	3SG	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-ja</i>	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-ja</i>	<i>-ja</i>
	1PL	<i>-unk</i>	<i>-unk</i>	<i>-juk</i>	-	<i>-unk</i>	<i>-juk</i>	<i>-unk</i>
	2PL	<i>-tok</i>	<i>-tok</i>	<i>-játok</i>	<i>-tok</i>	-	<i>-játok</i>	<i>-tok</i>
	3PL	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-ják</i>	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-ják</i>	<i>-juk</i>

Table 3

As discussed above, within this system, *-lak* 1SG>2 has long been a subject of intense debate, as it does not obviously fit either the definite or the indefinite paradigm.

There are cases where the contrast between definite and indefinite agreement is neutralized, e.g. with PAST-1SG:

		finite verb (<i>past tense</i>)						infinitive
		type of object						
		none	nominal		pronominal			
			indefinite	definite	1	2	3	
no min al	SG	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-ja</i>	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-ja</i>	<i>-ja</i>
	PL	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-ják</i>	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-ják</i>	<i>-juk</i>
pro no min al	1SG	<i>-m</i>	<i>-m</i>	<i>-m</i>	<i>-</i>	<i>-lak</i>	<i>-m</i>	<i>-m</i>
	2SG	<i>-l</i>	<i>-l</i>	<i>-d</i>	<i>-l</i>	<i>-</i>	<i>-d</i>	<i>-d</i>
	3SG	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-ja</i>	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-Ø</i>	<i>-ja</i>	<i>-ja</i>
	1PL	<i>-unk</i>	<i>-unk</i>	<i>-juk</i>	<i>-</i>	<i>-unk</i>	<i>-juk</i>	<i>-unk</i>
	2PL	<i>-tok</i>	<i>-tok</i>	<i>-játok</i>	<i>-tok</i>	<i>-</i>	<i>-játok</i>	<i>-tok</i>
	3PL	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-ják</i>	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-nak</i>	<i>-ják</i>	<i>-juk</i>

Table 4

At this point, a terminological note is in order: because of the identity of agreement markers in the “no object” and “indefinite object” scenarios, indefinite agreement is often described (and analyzed) as the lack of object agreement. In this terminology, all subjects trigger subject agreement, but only definite objects trigger object agreement. From now on, we will use this terminology throughout the paper.

Infinitivals optionally agree with their subject (and do not agree with their object, if any), and the infinitival subject agreement marker is identical to the corresponding possessedness suffix (a suffix which indexes possessedness and the person and number of the possessor): because of this, most authors consider the infinitival paradigm to be nominal.

		finite verb (present tense)						infinitive	possess- edness suffix
		type of object							
		none	nominal		pronominal				
			indefinite	definite	1	2	3		
no min al	SG	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-ja	-ja
	PL	-nak	-nak	-ják	-nak	-nak	-ják	-juk	-juk
pro no min al	1SG	-k	-k	-m	-	-lak	-m	-m	-m
	2SG	-sz / -l	-sz / -l	-d	-sz / -l	-	-d	-d	-d
	3SG	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-ja	-ja
	1PL	-unk	-unk	-juk	-	-unk	-juk	-unk	-unk
	2PL	-tok	-tok	-játok	-tok	-	-játok	-tok	-tok
	3PL	-nak	-nak	-ják	-nak	-nak	-ják	-juk	-juk

Table 5

3. INF+LAK: an old innovation

The empirical focus of this paper is the appearance of *-lak* 1SG>2 on infinitivals:

(2) *Rettenetesen nézel ki, nincs mese, azonnal...*

‘You look terrible, no kidding, without delay...

a. ... *be kell vin-n-em téged a kórházba!*

PRT must take-INF-1SG you.ACC the hospital.into

b. ... *be kell (hogy) vi-gye-lek (téged) a kórházba!*

PRT must that take-SUBJ-1SG>2 you.ACC the hospital.into

c. ... *be kell vin-ne-lek (téged) a kórházba!*

PRT must take-INF-1SG>2 you.ACC the hospital.into

... I have to take you to the hospital.'

		finite verb (present tense)						infinitive	possess -edness suffix	
		type of object								
		none	nominal		pronominal					
			indefinite	definite	1	2	3			
no min al	SG	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-ja	-ja	
	PL	-nak	-nak	-ják	-nak	-nak	-ják	-juk	-juk	
pro no min al	1SG	-k	-k	-m	-	-lak	-m	-m	-lak	-m
	2SG	-sz / -l	-sz / -l	-d	-sz / -l	-	-d	-d	-d	-d
	3SG	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-ja	-ja	-ja
	1PL	-unk	-unk	-juk	-	-unk	-juk	-unk	-unk	-unk
	2PL	-tok	-tok	-játok	-tok	-	-játok	-tok	-tok	-tok
	3PL	-nak	-nak	-ják	-nak	-nak	-ják	-juk	-juk	-juk

Table 6

The use of *-lak* 1SG>2 on infinitivals is ungrammatical for the majority of native speakers and it has been frowned upon by prescriptive linguists. However, it has had a long and stable presence in Hungarian for almost 400 years. As far as current usage is concerned, it is easy to find hundreds of attestations on the internet:

(3) *Meg kell hív-na-lak egy itatra!*

PRT must invite-INF-1SG>2 a drink.onto

'I have to buy you a drink.'

(4) *Mostantól nálam laksz szóval el kell visel-ne-lek.*

now.from at.me live.2SG so PRT must tolerate-INF-1SG>2

'From now on, you are living at my place so I have to put up with you.'

(5) *Bocs csak gyönyörű vagy és muszáj volt néz-ne-lek.*

sorry only beautiful be.2SG and must was see-INF-1SG>2

Amúgy Ricsi vagyok.

by.the.way Ricsi be.1SG

'I am sorry but you are so beautiful I had to keep looking at you. I am Ricsi, by the way.'

Also, there are dozens of attestations in 'official' synchronic and diachronic corpora such as the HPLT Corpus (De Gibert et al. 2024)², the Hungarian National Corpus (Váradí, Oravecz & Sass 2014), the Hungarian Historical Corpus (Csengery 2006) and GoogleBooks. Note that these counts probably underestimate the magnitude of the phenomenon, as due to the peculiarities of Hungarian morphology and orthography, plus the tendency of people to not use accents in electronic communications (*a* vs. *á*), these constructions are difficult to detect algorithmically. This is because modulo accents (*a* vs. *á*), the following two forms are orthographically identical:

² I would like to thank Ágnes Kalivoda for designing and executing the necessary search strategy.

(6) a. *néz-ne-lek* *néznelek* (official spelling) *neznelek* (sloppy spelling)

watch-INF-1SG>2

'(for me) to watch you'

b. *néz-né-lek* *néznelek* (official spelling) *neznelek* (sloppy spelling)

watch-COND-1SG>2

'(I) would watch you'

4. Literature overview

4.1 Descriptive literature on INF+*lak*

The first brief description of this phenomenon is found in the descriptive grammar of Geleji Katona (1645). Academic linguists have first noted this phenomenon at the end of the 19th century: Simonyi (1888) claimed that it was characteristic of Transylvanian Hungarian, this however was challenged by Horger (1900) who assumed that Simonyi has confused the INF+*lak* phenomenon with the Balkan subjunctive. Klemm (1925) noted the infinitival use of *-lak* without providing any analysis. Horger (1900) hypothesized that the construction was invented by adherents of the early 19th century language reform (*nyelvújítás*) movement. Later, he revised this implausible position and argued that the phenomenon is simply a performance error (Horger 1931). The fact that this construction is well attested in edited, cultivated texts (such as theatre plays and novels) makes such an explanation unconvincing. Zolnai (1889) argued that INF+*lak* arose as a result of analogy: the use of *-lak* spread spontaneously from the finite to the infinitival paradigm. While this is a plausible account as far as the mechanism of language change is concerned, it does not address what the availability of INF+*lak* reveals about the synchronic status, category and morphosyntactic position of *-lak*. In addition to the descriptive accounts discussed above, the phonology of the construction has been briefly discussed in a more theoretical vein by Honti 2020. Due to its widespread nature, it has also elicited the interest of prescriptive linguists (Grétsy 2008) and sociolinguists Lanstyák (2023) too. To sum up, while this construction has been known for some time, it has not yet been systematically explored from a morphosyntactic perspective.

4.2 Previous analyses of verbal agreement in Hungarian

The theoretical literature concerning the morphosyntax and semantics of verbal agreement in Hungarian is vast. For reasons of space, we cannot offer a full review here (for more details, we recommend the recent overviews provided in Bárány 2017 and Coppock 2022; and the contributions in this volume). In what follows, we discuss the major analytical directions in such detail as is sufficient for the contextualization of our specific proposal.

Throughout the literature, there is broad agreement that object agreement is sensitive to definiteness. However, there is significant divergence as to how definiteness is encoded. Coppock & Wechsler 2012 and Coppock 2013, 2022, have argued for a semantic model of definiteness agreement. Bartos (1999) has argued that object agreement is strictly sensitive to the presence or absence of a DP layer on the object nominal (or pronoun). Bárány (2017) has claimed that the trigger of definite agreement is a person feature on the D head grammaticalizing referentiality.

The exact mechanism of how agreement is mediated is also contested:

	subject agreement	object agreement
Bartos (1999)	AgrS	AgrO
Den Dikken (2004, 2006)	T[Infl]	AgrO/v
Bárány (2017)	T	V

Table 7

There are also competing accounts of the peculiar pronominal agreement pattern. Bartos (1999) argues the 1 and 2 person pronouns are NumPs whereas 3 person pronouns are DPs – and it is only DP objects that trigger object agreement (in this approach, indefinite agreement is taken to be the lack of object agreement). É. Kiss (2013a) captures the data by recourse to the animacy hierarchy 1SG>{1PL;2}>3; argued to be a relic from the diachrony of the language. In Bárány’s (2017) analysis, all pronouns are DPs and trigger object agreement, which, however, is not always spelled out (the person hierarchy here is captured in terms of superset-set feature relations). In Den Dikken’s analysis (2004, 2006): 1 and 2 pronouns are PossPs, and their covert possessors are realised as clitics.

The status of the agreement markers in general, and that of *-lak* 1SG>2 specifically, is also debated. Bartos argues that they are exponents of AgrS and AgrO. Bárány (2017) claims that they are portmanteau morphemes which spell out the feature content of a merged T+v head: in this account, *-lak* is a fully regular form [1SG>2]. Several authors (E. Abaffy 1991, Bartos 1999, Den Dikken 2004, 2006, É. Kiss 2013a, 2017, Havas 2004, Honti 2020, Hegedűs 2020) have argued that *-lak* can be decomposed into object agreement marker *-l-* and subject agreement marker *-k*. In Den Dikken’s (2004, 2006) model, some of the agreement markers are suffixes and others are clitics; as far as *-lak* is concerned, *-l-* is an object clitic and *-k* is a subject agreement suffix.

4.3. Previous analyses of infinitives and agreement in Hungarian

Hungarian is well-known for having agreeing infinitives (cf. Tóth 2000 and É. Kiss 2002 for detailed expositions). Agreement is obligatory (in the conservative dialect) with monadic predicates (epistemic modals, non-directed deontic modals, nominal predicates), where the dative-marked argument is the subject of the infinitival clause:

- (7) *Mari-nak₁ otthon₂ kell [t₁ t₂ len-ni-e]*

Mary-DAT at.home must be-INF-3SG

‘Mary must be at home.’

- (8) *Szemtelenség [János-nak ennyit kés-ni-e]*

impertinence John-DAT this.much be.late-INF-3SG

‘For John to be this late is an act of impertinence.’

Agreement is optional with dyadic predicates where dative-marked argument can be interpreted as a dative experiencer and/or the subject of the infinitival:

(9) *Mari-nak előnyös részt ven-ni(-e) a konferencián.*

Mary-DAT beneficial PRT take-INF-3SG the conference.SUP

'It is beneficial for Mary [for Mary to participate at the conference].'

Agreement is impossible if the dative-marked element is clearly an argument of the matrix clause:

(10) *Segítek a gyerek-ek-nek [megír-ni-(*uk)] a leckét.*

help.1SG the kid-PL-DAT write-INF-3PL the homework.ACC

'I am helping the kids to do their homework.'

Thus, the main explananda are the following (i) the dative-marked subject, (ii) the lack of object agreement, (iii) the fact that agreement suffixes strictly identical to possessor-marking suffixes (see tables above). The theoretical approaches broadly fall into two camps: the verbal analysis and the nominal (or mixed-projection) analysis.

In the verbal analysis (Bartos 1999, Tóth 2000), infinitives are analysed as an extended verbal projection that lacks an AgrO layer (hence no object agreement), with an AgrS layer functioning as the locus of subject agreement. AgrS[-Tense,+Agr] is taken to assign dative case to the subject (as opposed to AgrS[+Tense,+Agr], which assigns nominative case to the subject).

To the contrary, É. Kiss (2002) analyzes infinitives as nominal (mixed) projections. The roots of this analysis lie in the observation that so-called possessor-marking suffixes in fact have a more general function of expressing „relatedness in the manner determined by the lexical head” (Szabolcsi 1983, 1994 and Alberti 1995):

(11) a. *János-nak a ház-a* possession

John-DAT the house-3SG

'John's house'

b. *János-nak a láb-a* part-whole relation

John-DAT the leg-3SG

'John's leg'

c. *János-nak a ap-ja* genealogical relation

John-DAT the father-3SG

'John's father'

d. *János-nak a iskola-ja* locational relation

John-DAT the house-3SG

'John's school'

e. *János-nak a kiabál-ás-a* thematic relation

John-DAT the shout-NMNZ-3SG

'John's shouting'

f. *János-nak a megver-és-e* thematic relation

John-DAT the beat-NMNZ-3SG

'the beating of John'

É. Kiss (2002) (see also Alberti 2020 and Farkas 2020) expands upon this and analyzes (agreeing) infinitives as a nominal (or mixed) projection. Consider:

(12) a. *Mari-nak (*a) kiabál-ni-a* [*hiba volt*]

Mary-DAT the shout-INF-3SG mistake was

'for Mary to shout [was a mistake]'

b. *János-nak *(a) kiabál-ás-a* [*elviselhetetlen volt*]

John-DAT the shout-NMNZ-3SG insufferable was

'John's shouting [was insufferable]'

In this account, the infinitival suffix *-ni-* is a nominalizer like *-ás-*, although with crucial differences (i) *ás-* nominalization projects to DP whereas *ni-* nominalization projects only to NP and (ii) *ni-* nominalizations have a more developed left periphery (AspP, FP, NegP, DistP, TopP, even CP for some speakers) (see Alberti 2020 for more details).

The mixed-projection analysis provides an elegant and parsimonious account for all three explananda. The „subjects” of infinitivals are dative marked because they are not subjects but, in fact, possessors. Object agreement is absent because verbal agreement in general is absent – infinitivals are nominal projections (on the relevant level). Subject agreement markers are identical to possessedness suffixes because they actually *are* possessedness suffixes. (A mixed projection analysis also has typological and diachronic plausibility as mixed-projection analyses concerning converbs, gerunds, nominalizations, infinitivals are well-established in various languages related to Hungarian, including nominalizations with rich left peripheries.)

The appearance of *-lak* 1SG>2 (an overt subject-object agreement marker) on the infinitival paradigm does pose a challenge though – this is clearly not a possessedness (relatedness) marker. *Prima facie*, one could take this observation to mean that the verbal analysis (Bartos 1999 and Tóth 2000) maybe does have an edge over the nominal analysis (É. Kiss 2002, Alberti 2020). However, in what follows, we will argue that the situation is more complex: both accounts are valid simultaneously.

5. Infinitivals and object agreement revisited

Before considering the theoretical repercussions of the emergence in the innovative dialect of infinitival *-lak* 1SG>2, we should take a step back and reconsider the orthodoxy that there is no object agreement in the infinitival paradigm in the non-innovative dialect the first place. It is clear

that there are no visible (overt) markers of object agreement, but does this automatically mean that object agreement is indeed structurally absent?

It is well-known that in the finite realm, there are cases where subject vs. subject-object agreement is neutralized (PAST-1SG):

- (13) a. *Lát-t-am egy ház-at* b. *Lát-t-am a ház-at*
 see-past-1SG a house-ACC see-past-1SG>OBJ the house-ACC

Most authors would agree that in (13b), the verb does agree with the definite object; only, for some reason, this is not visible on the surface.

Beyond such clear-cut cases of neutralization, many authors have cogently argued that object agreement is systematically not spelled out in many more configurations: Bárányi (2017) argues that contrary to appearances, all pronouns always trigger object agreement; Den Dikken (2004, 2006) operates with null clitics. Thus, the invisibility of an object agreement marker cannot be taken as definitive proof for the lack of object agreement. How can we detect morphophonologically invisible but syntactically active object agreement?

Bárányi (2017) proposes two tests: object pronoun drop and association with depictives. Let us consider object pronoun drop in more detail. Hungarian is a heavily pro-drop language: both object as well as subject pronouns are dropped very frequently. Bárányi (2017) argues that pro-drop can be used a diagnostic for the presence of object agreement. Consider (14) below:

- (14) *Lát-om.*
 see-???
 *i. 'I see.' (i.e., I have the ability to see.)
 *ii. 'I see you.'
 iii. 'I see her/him/it.'
 -> *-m* spells out [1SG>3]

(14) is a full sentence with subject drop as well as object drop. Focusing on just the SG forms for simplicity, we observe that the only available reading is that in (iii): 1SG subject and 3SG object. Thus, we can conclude that *-m* spells out [1SG>3]. By the same token, we can establish that *-lak* spells out [1SG>2]:

- (15) *Lát-lak.*
 see-???
 *i. 'I see.' (i.e., I have the ability to see.)
 ii. 'I see you.'
 *iii. 'I see her/him/it.'
 -> *-lak* spells out [1SG>2]

Considering (16) below, we can establish that in the presence of T[past], *-am* spells out [1SG] (1SG subject agreement and no object agreement) as well as [1SG>3].

(16) *Lát-t-am.*

see-PAST-???

i. 'I saw.' (i.e., I had the ability to see.)

*ii. 'I see you.'

iii. 'I see her/him/it.'

-> *-am* (after past) spells out [1SG] as well as [1SG>3]

Having seen how this diagnostic works, let us now apply it to infinitival agreement. Consider:

- (17) a. (*Nekem*) *be* *kell* *vin-n-em* *téged* *a* *kórházba.*
 1SG.DAT PRT must take-INF-1SG you.ACC the hospital.into
- b. (*Nekem*) *be* *kell* *vin-n-em* *őt* *a* *kórházba.*
 1SG.DAT PRT must take-INF-1SG she.ACC the hospital.into

If there is indeed no object agreement (as has been argued by Bartos 1999, Tóth 2000 and É. Kiss 2002), then no object pro-drop should be possible. If we find object pro-drop, this suggests there is object agreement after all. Consider

- (18) *Be* *kell* *vin-n-em* *a* *kórházba.*
 PRT must take-INF-1SG the hospital.into
- i. 'I have to take her to the hospital.'
- *ii. 'I have to take you to the hospital.'

The first thing we can observe is that (17) is perfectly acceptable and natural: object pro-drop is possible, which strongly suggests that there is object agreement with infinitivals too (contra É. Kiss, Bartos and Tóth).

However, it also appears that pro-drop is sensitive to the type of object: it looks as if a 3SG object can be dropped but a 2SG object cannot. This is a very surprising observation. Further testing, however, reveals that this is indeed a robust pattern. Consider:

- (19) *Mari szörnyen néz ki! Azonnal be kell vin-n-em a kórházba.*
 at.once PRT must take-INF-1SG the hospital.into
- 'Mary looks terrible! I have to take her to the hospital right away.'

- (20) *Te szörnyen nézel ki! Azonnal be kell vin-n-em a kórházba.*
 at.once PRT must take-INF-1SG the hospital.into
- i. 'You look terrible! #I have to take you to the hospital right away.'
- ii. 'You look terrible! I have to take her (someone else) to the hospital right away.'

Note that in (20), the two potential continuations contrast heavily in terms of plausibility: (20i) is highly plausible as a continuation whereas (20ii) is highly implausible. And yet, speaker judgements are crystal clear: the reading in (20i) is completely unavailable – the only available reading is the highly improbable reading in (20ii).

To sum up, the emerging picture is this:

- (21) a. *Be kell vin-n-em *(téged) a kórházba.*
 PRT must take-INF-1SG you.ACC the hospital.into
 'I have to take you to the hospital.'
- b. *Be kell vin-n-em (őt) a kórházba.*
 PRT must take-INF-1SG she.ACC the hospital.into
 'I have to take her to the hospital.'

We can observe the following general empirical pattern with infinitivals: object drop is possible with all subject-object combinations, except with 1SG>2, where the availability of object pro-drop is conditioned by the exponent of agreement (we focus on SG objects, as pro-drop with plural objects is less reliable as a test in general):

	1SG	2SG	3SG
1SG	-	<i>be kell vin-n-em *(téged)</i> PRT musttake-INF-1SG you <i>be kell vin-n-elek (téged)</i> PRT musttake-INF-1SG>2 you	<i>be kell vin-n-em (őt)</i> PRT musttake-INF-1SG her
2SG	<i>be kell vin-n-ed (engem)</i> PRT musttake-INF-2SG me	-	<i>be kell vin-n-ed (őt)</i> PRT musttake-INF-2SG her
3SG	<i>be kell vin-ni-e (engem)</i> PRT musttake-INF-3SG me	<i>be kell vin-ni-e (téged)</i> PRT musttake-INF-3SG you	<i>be kell vin-ni-e (őt)</i> PRT musttake-INF-3SG her

Table 8

To summarize:

- Object pronoun drop is possible in every cell of the paradigm
- With 1SG>2, the availability of object pronoun-drop is conditioned by the exponent of agreement:
 - *-m* [qua exponent of 1SG>2] does not license object pronoun drop
 - *-lak* [1SG>2] licenses object pronoun drop

These empirical observations are clear-cut and solid, and they present a serious challenge to the existing theoretical accounts. If we adopt the mixed projection analysis of É. Kiss (2002), we do not have object agreement at all – how can we explain object pro drop? The verbal projection analysis of Bartos and Tóth appears at first sight to be salvageable: one could simply assume that infinitivals also have an AgrO layer after all (just like finite forms). However, this does not solve the second riddle: adopting an AgrS+AgrO analysis, how do we explain the conditionality of object pro-drop on the exponent of AgrS+AgrO (*-m* vs. *-lak*)?

6. A competing-grammars account

Before formulating a possible account, consider the paradigm again:

		finite verb (<i>past</i> tense)						infinitive
		type of object						
		none	nominal		pronominal			
			indefinite	definite	1	2	3	
no min al	SG	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-ja
	PL	-nak	-nak	-ják	-nak	-nak	-ják	-juk
pro no min al	1SG	-m	-m	-m	-	-lak	-m	-m
	2SG	-l	-l	-d	-l	-	-d	-d
	3SG	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-Ø	-Ø	-ja	-ja
	1PL	-unk	-unk	-juk	-	-unk	-juk	-unk
	2PL	-tok	-tok	-játok	-tok	-	-játok	-tok
	3PL	-nak	-nak	-ják	-nak	-nak	-ják	-juk

We can make the following striking observations:

- Observation 1: object pro drop is only possible with agreement markers that are surface-similar across the finite and the non-finite paradigm
- Observation 2: there is a near-total overlap between the agreement marker inventories (finite vs. non-finite/possessive) – for diachronic reasons: the consensus position in Uralic linguistics is that both agreement markers and possessedness suffixes go back to personal pronouns along the cross-linguistically attested pronoun > clitic > affix cline.

These observations provide the starting point of our proposal. The near-total overlap between the agreement marker inventories means that speakers can easily hold two competing grammars in their heads and not even know it: (i) infinitives as a nominal (mixed) projection and (ii) infinitives as a verbal projection. Except with 1>2SG, where there is a stark difference between the two paradigms, so the choice of *-m* clearly marks out the projection as nominal and the choice of *-lak* marks it out as verbal: this explains why object drop is disallowed in the former case but allowed in the latter case.

More precisely, our proposal is that in Modern Hungarian, speakers have access to two competing grammars wrt infinitivals: Grammar N and Grammar V. Moreover, Grammar V comes in two varieties: the conservative Grammar V_{deficient} and the innovative Grammar V_{full} (the latter is attested from the Late Middle Hungarian period onward).

In Grammar N, infinitivals are a nominal (mixed) projection, along the lines of É. Kiss (2002): under Grammar N, there is no verbal agreement and hence, object pro-drop is disallowed. In Grammar V, infinitivals are verbal projection and thus, they exhibit verbal agreement (subject as well as object agreement): hence, object pro-drop is allowed under Grammar V.

The fact that object pro-drop in infinitivals is allowed in Modern Hungarian (subject to the restriction discussed above) indicates that most (maybe all) speakers are subject to a competing grammar scenario (N vs.V). If speakers only had Grammar N, no object pro-drop would be possible. If speakers only had Grammar V, object pro-drop would be possible across the board (see discussion below), contrary to the facts discussed above.

Crucially, Grammar V comes in two varieties. In Grammar $V_{\text{deficient}}$, there is a paradigm gap in cell 1SG>2 (the only cell where verbal agreement markers and possessedness markers are not surface-similar): INF-1SG>2 forms are ineffable under Grammar $V_{\text{deficient}}$. Grammar V_{full} is Grammar V without any paradigm gap (in cell 1SG>2, the exponent of S+O agreement is *-lak*).

Furthermore, I propose that there exist two tribes of Hungarians. In Tribe 1, there is competition between Grammar N and Grammar $V_{\text{deficient}}$. This means that in Tribe 1, competition reigns in all cells except 1SG>2 (as Grammar $V_{\text{deficient}}$ does not cover cell 1SG>2). As consequence, for speakers belonging to Tribe 1, object pro-drop is allowed (via Grammar $V_{\text{deficient}}$) in all cells except 1SG>2.

In Tribe 2, there is competition between Grammar N and Grammar V_{full} . This means that in Tribe 2, competition reigns in all cells between Grammar N and Grammar V_{full} . In Tribe 2, object pro-drop is licensed in all cells (via Grammar V_{full}).

I argue that Grammar N is the earlier one: Hungarian used to be SOV with non-finite subordination involving nominalizations (mixed projections) (Dékány 2014). SOV-to-SVO change, a change Hungarian underwent in the Old Hungarian period (É. Kiss 2013b), is cross-linguistically highly correlated with the retrenchment of nominalization (and non-finite subordination more generally) as a subordination strategy. Because of the high degree of overlap between verbal agreement morphology and possessedness morphology, the alternative interpretation of infinitival as a verbal projection (Grammar V) was prone to develop fairly easily.

Note that this analysis assumes that in Grammar V, there is widespread PF-neutralization of the contrast between S agreement and S+O agreement:

- (22) a. [1SG>{0;1}]: *-m*
 b. [1SG>2]: paradigm gap in $V_{\text{deficient}}$, *-lak* in V_{full}
 c. [2SG>X]: *-d*
 d. [3SG>X]: *-a*

This assumption is fairly innocent to make, however, since the mechanism of neutralization sensitive to the feature content of T is already available in the language (e.g. 1SG>X gets neutralized in the context of T[+past]). Because of this, it appears justified to invoke the very same mechanism in the context of T[+inf]. (See Section 7 below for a more detailed and concrete implementation.)

Why is it exactly the cell [1>2SG] which is a paradigm gap in $V_{\text{deficient}}$? The answer probably lies in the diachrony: Grammar V originates as a reinterpretation of Grammar N, and *-lak* is absent from Grammar N. Indeed, one could argue that Grammar N and Grammar $V_{\text{deficient}}$ can compete by stealth, as it were, as the verbal and the possessedness suffixes are surface-identical. The price of this stable coexistence between Grammar N and Grammar $V_{\text{deficient}}$ is the toleration of the paradigm gap in Grammar $V_{\text{deficient}}$. Once this gap is resolved (i.e., once we move from $V_{\text{deficient}}$ to V_{full}), the cover of competition-by-stealth is blown as *-lak* [1>2SG] is an unequivocally verbal suffix, marking out the infinitival as a verbal (non-mixed, non-nominal) projection.

Before concluding this section, let us consider the relative advantages of each system. In the grammar of speakers belonging to Tribe 1, there is silent competition between Grammar N and Grammar $V_{\text{deficient}}$. Grammar N covers every cell but does not allow object pro-drop; Grammar

$V_{\text{deficient}}$ is deficient (in one cell) but does allow object pro-drop in most cells. Thus, speakers in Tribe 1 have object pro-drop in most (but not all) cells.

In the grammar of speakers belonging to Tribe 2, there is competition between Grammar N and Grammar V_{full} . Grammar N covers every cell but does not allow object pro-drop. Grammar V_{full} covers every cell and allows object pro-drop in every cell.

To sum up, in Tribe 1, the competition between Grammar N and Grammar $V_{\text{deficient}}$ is clandestine in the sense that the output of the two grammars are surface-identical (*modulo* 1>2SG, where Grammar $V_{\text{deficient}}$ produces no output). This creates a diachronically stable competition, at the price of object pro-drop being impossible in cell 1>2SG. Note also that each grammar has its own advantage and disadvantage: Grammar N is gap-free (but fails to license object pro-drop); Grammar $V_{\text{deficient}}$ licenses object pro-drop (but has a gap in the paradigm). The twin facts that (i) the two grammars produce identical output and that (ii) none of them has a clear advantage over the other jointly produce a stable equilibrium, where none of the grammars is able to crowd out the other.

In Tribe 2, the competition is open since the outputs of the two grammars (N and V_{full}) are not surface identical (albeit in just one cell: 1>2SG). Also, in Tribe 2, one of the grammars has a clear advantage over the other: both N and V_{full} are full (gap-free) paradigms – however, V_{full} allows object pro-drop while N does not. This would suggest that V_{full} should gradually crowd out N within Tribe 2; and later on, through contact between Tribe 1 and Tribe 2, V_{full} should crowd out N and $V_{\text{deficient}}$ in Tribe 1 too.

This prediction, however, appears not to have been born out yet. V_{full} is attested from the middle of the 17th century at the latest, and yet, in the three and a half centuries that has elapsed since, it failed to have conquered Hungarian – indeed, INF+*lak* is ungrammatical for the majority of speakers today.

Why is this the case? There are three factors to consider. First, let us revisit whether belonging to Tribe 2 is indeed substantially advantageous to belonging to Tribe 1. In Tribe 2, object pro-drop is licensed in all 6 cells; in Tribe 1, it is licensed in 5 out of 6 cells – arguably a relatively minor advantage. Since in Tribe 2, Grammar V_{full} is on the way to crowding out Grammar N, Tribe 2 will soon have the additional advantage of its speaker only having one grammar for infinitives (V_{full}) as opposed to Tribe 1 (two competing grammars: N and $V_{\text{deficient}}$). However, speakers presumably store a plethora of competing grammars in their heads anyway, so this advantage may also be of limited consequence. Secondly, infinitival agreement as such is a limited and receding phenomenon in Modern Hungarian: even for conservative speakers, infinitival agreement is only mandatory with monadic predicates – and less conservative speakers often drop infinitival agreement even with monadic predicates too. Thirdly: the Balkan subjunctive (Joseph 1983) is taking Hungarian by a storm (É. Kiss 2022): the pressure to de-nominalize infinitival subordination already has an established outlet supported by areal effects.

7. Verbal models of infinitives

In this section, we consider to what extent infinitives qua verbal projection can be handled in the frameworks developed by Den Dikken (2004, 2006) and Bárány (2017). Note that both authors have developed their models for the finite paradigm – so this will be an exercise in exploring whether the empirical coverage of both models can be extended to cover infinitivals as well.

7.1 Den Dikken (2004, 2006)

In Den Dikken's (2004, 2006) system (developed for the finite paradigm), agreement markers are of different types:

(23) Den Dikken's (2004, 2006) proposal (finite paradigm)

- a. subject clitics: 1SG (*-m*) and 2SG (*-d*)
- b. subject agreement suffixes: 1SG (*-k*), 2SG (*-sz/-l*), 1PL (*-uk*), 2PL (*-tok*)
- c. object clitics: 1SG (null), 2SG (*-l* if the subject is 1, null if the subject is 3), 3SG (*-ja*)

Thus, object agreement (and in part, subject agreement also) is taken to be clitic doubling. Additionally, Den Dikken stipulates that there is a cooccurrence restriction on 1SG and 2SG subject clitics $\{-m|-d\}$ and the 3SG object clitic *-ja*. This ensures that the forms in (24a) are not produced, instead, the forms in (24b) surface:

- (24) a. **lát-ja-m* **lát-ja-d*
 see-3SG-1SG see-3SG-2SG
 int. 'I see it.' int. 'You see it.'
- b. *lát-om* *lát-od*
 see-1SG see-2SG
 'I see it.' 'You see it.'

Crucially, while the 1SG (*-m*) and 2SG (*-d*) subject *clitics* appear with agreement-triggering objects, and 1SG (*-k*), 2SG (*-sz/-l*) subject agreement *suffixes* appear otherwise, the subject clitics themselves are not specified for object agreement in this system.

7.2 A Den Dikken-style verbal model of infinitives (Grammar $V_{\text{deficient}}$)

The first question is to what extent the infinitival pattern (25) can be handled in this system (assuming that infinitivals are verbal).

- (25) a. [1SG>2], [1SG>3] (and [1SG]) are spelled out as *-m*
 b. [2SG>1], [2SG>3] (and [2SG]) are spelled out as *-d*
 c. [3SG>1], [3SG>2], [3SG>3] (and [3SG]) are spelled out as *-ja*
 d. [1SG>2]: paradigm gap

We submit that Den Dikken's system can account for the infinitival pattern ($V_{\text{deficient}}$), with two modifications: one modification which is major but plausible, and one modification which is minor and not implausible. The proposed system is as follows:

(26) Den Dikken-style proposal ($V_{\text{deficient}}$ infinitival paradigm)

- a. subject clitics: 1SG (*-m*) and 2SG (*-d*)
- b. subject agreement suffixes: THERE ARE NONE
- c. object clitics: 1SG (*-ja*), 2SG (*-ja*), 3SG (*-ja*)

Note first that the subject agreement suffixes (1SG (*-k*), 2SG (*-sɔ̃/-l*)) are excluded from the infinitival paradigm – only clitics are admitted. This strikes us as plausible: Den Dikken regards subject agreement *suffixes* as relatively recent innovations – infinitives being more conservative contexts than finite clauses, this might explain their absence. This, in conjunction with the injunction against combining subject clitics with object clitics, explains (25ab).

The other change to Den Dikken's system is related to the pattern in (25c). In contrast to the finite paradigm, where the 1SG object clitic is null, 2SG object clitic is null or *-l* (depending on the subject) and the 3SG object clitic is *-ja*; in the infinitival paradigm, all object clitics have the same form *-ja*. This would be a situation where object clitics display allomorphy conditioned on the feature content of T (+finite vs. +inf). (Note again that in the finite realm, it is well-known that certain contrasts are neutralized depending on the feature content of T, cf. (13) above.)

7.3 A Den Dikken-style verbal model of infinitives (Grammar V_{full})

Consider now the innovative Grammar V_{full} . Here, we have the following system:

- (27)
- a. [1SG>3] (and [1SG]) are spelled out as *-m*
 - b. [2SG>1], [2SG>3] (and [2SG]) are spelled out as *-d*
 - c. [3SG>1], [3SG>2], [3SG>3] (and [3SG]) are spelled out as *-ja*
 - d. [1SG>2] is spelled out as *-lak*

We propose the following model:

(28) Den Dikken-style proposal (V_{full} infinitival paradigm)

- a. subject clitics: 1SG (*-m*) and 2SG (*-d*)
- b. subject agreement suffixes: 1SG (*-k*)
- c. object clitics: 1SG (*-ja*), 2SG (*-l* if the subject is 1, *-ja* if the subject is 3), 3SG (*-ja*)

Thinking in Den Dikken's (2004, 2006) system, the arrival of *-lak* implies that the 1SG (*-k*) subject agreement suffix has appeared on the stage, as well as the allomorph *-l* of the 2SG object clitic. Note, however, the system outlined in (28) above would predict the existence of the forms in (29), contrary to fact:

- (29) a. **nekem lát-ni-ok valamit*
 1SG.DAT see-INF-1SG something
 'for me to see something'
- b. **neked lát-ni-ol valamit*
 2SG.DAT see-INF-2SG something
 'for me to see something'

Can we explain why the contrast between definite and indefinite agreement is neutralized with 1SG and 2SG subjects in the infinitival paradigm (V_{full})? Note that this is the exact same pattern that we observe in past contexts (see (13) above): thus, whatever mechanism one implements for past contexts is likely to carry over to infinitivals as well: the neutralization is conditional to the feature content of T. Thus, we can conclude that the emergence of infinitival *-lak* is relatively straightforward to accomodate in Den Dikken's (2004, 2006) system.

7.4 Bárány (2017)

In Bárány's (2017) system, objects trigger definite agreement if and only if they are DPs and D has a(n abstract) person feature. Also, while v can agree both with the object and the subject (under specific circumstances), T only agrees with the subject. All pronouns are taken to be DPs with D having a person feature: thus, all pronouns trigger object agreement. However, object agreement (definiteness agreement) is only spelled out if v and T merge. In the finite paradigm, this is conditional on the relative position of subject pronoun and object pronoun, cast in terms of entailment (superset-set relations). The full details (cf. Chapter 2 and 3 of Bárány 2017) cannot be spelled out for reasons of space, but this is the end result:

SUBJ -> OBJ	1	2	3
1	-	T+v: [1,2]	T+v: [1,3]
2	T:[2], v:[1]	-	T+v: [2,3]
3	T:[3], v:[1]	T:[3], v:[2]	T+v: [3,3]

Table 10

Here, the feature content (person) of each head is given in square brackets. T+v indicates that T and v have been merged. In Bárány's (2017) system, only one node is spelled out: either T (if no merge happened) or T+v. In addition to the table above, a set of vocabulary insertion rules are provided, as well as impoverishment rules to cover the possessedness suffix – verbal agreement suffix overlap and past tense neutralization.

Focusing on the singular cases, these are the rules as per Bárány (2017) (I have slightly modified the notation for clarity):

Vocabulary Insertion rules:

- (30) a. $[1,x]/[+V] \leftrightarrow -ok$
 b. $[1,x] \leftrightarrow -om$
 c. $[1,2] \leftrightarrow -lak$

- d. [2,x]/[+V] <-> *-ol/-sʒ*
- e. [2,x] <-> *-od*
- f. [3,3] <-> *-ja*
- g. [3,x] <-> *-Ø*

Impoverishment rules:

- (31) a. [+V] -> -Ø / [+N] (possessor agreement)
- b. [+V] -> -Ø / [1,+PST] (neutralization in past tense)
- c. [+V] -> -Ø / [(1v2),3, SG] (derivation of pronominal agreement pattern)
- d. [+V] -> -Ø / [T=v=(1v2),SG] (derivation of pronominal agreement pattern)
- e. [+V] -> -Ø / [1, V belongs to *-ik*-class] (*-ik*-paradigm verbs)

7.5 Bárány (2017) revised

I propose the following limited (and in my view, natural and sensible) modifications to Bárány's (2017) original proposal (the changes are indicated by underlining>:

Vocabulary Insertion rules:

- (32) a. [1,x]/[+V] <-> *-ok*
- b. [1,x] <-> *-om*
- c. [1,2] <-> *-lak*
- d. [2,x]/[+V] <-> *-ol/-sʒ*
- e. [2,x] <-> *-od*
- f. [3,x] <-> *-ja*
- g. [3,x]/[+V] <-> *-Ø*

Impoverishment rules:

- (33) a. [+V] -> -Ø / [+N] (possessor agreement)
- b. [+V] -> -Ø / [1,+PST] (neutralization in past tense)
- c. [+V] -> -Ø / [(1v2v3),3, SG] (derivation of pronominal agreement pattern)
- d. [+V] -> -Ø / [T=v=(1v2),SG] (derivation of pronominal agreement pattern)
- e. [+V] -> -Ø / [1, V belongs to *-ik*-class] (*-ik*-paradigm verbs)

The first modification involves the substitution of the rules in (30fg) with the ones in (32fg). The second involves the substitution of the rule in (31c) with the one in (33c). These twin modifications are advantageous in three respects. Firstly, they make the system more uniform: in Bárány's original formulation, the feature [+V] played a role in the spellout of [1] and [2], but not of [3]. The system is now fully uniform across all three persons. Secondly, these modification allow us to capture the

full gamut of the isomorphism of subject agreement suffixes and possessor marking suffixes, extending the coverage to [3] too. Note that in order for this extension to work, one has to add a -*(j)e* -> *i* lenition rule to front-vowel verbal forms:

- (34) a. *gép-je* -> *gépje*
 machine-3sg
 'her/his machine'
- b. *tép-je* -> *tépje* -> lenition -> *tépi*
 tear-3sg
 'she/he tears (it)'

Such a lenition rule is phonologically plausible, and, in fact, the consensus view is that the suffix in question was indeed realized as -*(j)e* in reconstructed Early Old Hungarian.

Thirdly, these independently motivated modifications will allow as to account for both $V_{\text{deficient}}$ and V_{full} in a parsimonious and natural way. Consider first the $V_{\text{deficient}}$ paradigm.

7.6 A Bárányi-style verbal model of infinitives (Grammar $V_{\text{deficient}}$)

First try (to be revised)

The twin facts of (i) no visible reflex of object agreement and (ii) object agreement detected (via the object pro-drop test) can be accounted for by assuming that with infinitivals, T and v fail to merge across the board. This implies that whether or not T and v can merge is a function of the feature content of T (+finite vs. -finite): a not unreasonable assumption.

SUBJ -> OBJ	1	2	3
1	-	T:[1], v:[2]	T:[1], v:[3]
2	T:[2], v:[1]	-	T:[2], v:[3]
3	T:[3], v:[1]	T:[3], v:[2]	T:[3], v:[3]

Table 11

In order to cover the empirical pattern, only one modification is required, again signalled by underlining: Here is how to update the vocabulary insertion and impoverishment rules:

Vocabulary Insertion rules:

- (35) a. [1,x]/[+V] <-> -ok
- b. [1,x] <-> -om
- c. [1,2] <-> -lak
- d. [2,x]/[+V] <-> -ol/-s
- e. [2,x] <-> -od
- f. [3,x] <-> -ja

g. [3,x]/[+V] <-> -Ø

Impoverishment rules:

- (36) a. [+V] -> -Ø / [+N] (possessor agreement)
 b. [+V] -> -Ø / [1,+PST] (neutralization in past tense)
 c. [+V] -> -Ø / [(1v2v3),3, SG] (derivation of pronominal agreement pattern)
 d. [+V] -> -Ø / [T=v=(1v2),SG] (derivation of pronominal agreement pattern)
 e. [+V] -> -Ø / [1, V belongs to *-ik*-class] (*-ik*-paradigm verbs)
 f. [+V] -> -Ø / [+INF]

The modification is the addition of the impoverishment rule (34f) – the stipulation that [+V] be deleted in a [+INF] context is highly plausible, as infinitival forms are typically taken to be less verbal than non-infinitival forms.

Additionally, one has to stipulate that in $V_{\text{deficient}}$, there is a paradigm gap in the cell 1SG>2: verb-1SG>2 is ineffable in $V_{\text{deficient}}$. (Note that speakers of $V_{\text{deficient}}$ also have access to N, which does not have a paradigm gap in 1SG>2 – so they can produce a 1SG form of the infinitive *qua* mixed projection – this form, however, does not license object pro drop.)

It is, however, very difficult to provide a plausible operationalization for this gap. Since under our assumptions, T and v did not merge, we cannot refer to the feature content of a merged T+v head – instead, one would have to refer to the feature content of both T[1] and v[2] – and this would make any such rule unduly stipulative.

Second try

Because of this, we will explore another strategy too: one where the merge potential of T and v is not reduced with T[+inf]. Thus, the pattern of merge is the same across finite and infinitival forms:

SUBJ -> OBJ	1	2	3
1	-	T+v: [1,2]	T+v: [1,3]
2	T: [2], v: [1]	-	T+v: [2,3]
3	T: [3], v: [1]	T: [3], v: [2]	T+v: [3,3]

Table 12

The finite-system VI and spell-out rules will be modified as follows:

Vocabulary insertion rules:

- (37) a. [1,x]/[+V] <-> *-ok*
 b. [1,x] <-> *-om*
 c. [1,2]]/[+V] <-> *-lak*
 c. [1,2] <-> PARADIGM GAP
 d. [2,x]/[+V] <-> *-ol/-sʔ*
 e. [2,x] <-> *-od*

- f. [3,x] <-> *ja*
g. [3,x]/[+V] <-> -Ø

Impoverishment rules:

- (38) a. [+V] -> -Ø / [+N] (possessor agreement)
b. [+V] -> -Ø / [1,+PST] (neutralization in past tense)
c. [+V] -> -Ø / [(1v2v3),3, SG] (derivation of pronominal agreement pattern)
d. [+V] -> -Ø / [T=v=(1v2),SG] (derivation of pronominal agreement pattern)
e. [+V] -> -Ø / [1, V belongs to *-iké*-class] (*-iké*-paradigm verbs)
f. [+V] -> -Ø / [+INF]

This system covers both the finite and the non-finite ($V_{\text{deficient}}$) pattern. The modifications are plausible: infinitival forms are typically taken to be less verbal than non-infinitival forms (35f), and the bifurcation of the [1,2] vocabulary insertion rule is also plausible within the system (after this revision, all vocabulary insertion rules bifurcate along [+V] – the system is more exception-less than before). The only somewhat unmotivated element is rule [1,2] <-> PARADIGM GAP. Note, though, that paradigm gaps are often accidental when viewed from within the system. Of course, one can provide an external motivation for the place of the paradigm gap: the pressure to maintain the surface-identity between Grammars N and $V_{\text{deficient}}$.

7.7 A Bárányi-style verbal model of infinitives (Grammar V_{full})

Finally, V_{full} can be captured in a revised Bárányi (2017)-style system in the following way.

Merge rules:

SUBJ -> OBJ	1	2	3
1	-	T+v: [1,2]	T+v: [1,3]
2	T:[2], v:[1]	-	T+v: [2,3]
3	T:[3], v:[1]	T:[3], v:[2]	T+v: [3,3]

Table 13

Vocabulary Insertion rules:

- (39) a. [1]/[+V] <-> *-oké*
b. [1] <-> *-om*
c. [1,2]/[+V] <-> *-laké*
d. [2]/[+V] <-> *-ol/-szé*
e. [2] <-> *-od*
f. [3] <-> *ja*
g. [3]/[+V] <-> -Ø

Impoverishment rules:

- (40) a. [+V] → -Ø / [+N] (possessor agreement)
b. [+V] → -Ø / [1, +PST] (neutralization in past tense)
c. [+V] → -Ø / [(1v2v3), 3, SG] (derivation of pronominal agreement pattern)
d. [+V] → -Ø / [T=v=(1v2), SG] (derivation of pronominal agreement pattern)
e. [+V] → -Ø / [1, V belongs to *-iké*-class] (*-iké*-paradigm verbs)
f. [+V] → -Ø / [+INF]

Note that this system, which covers V_{full} , is almost identical the system originally devised only to account for the finite paradigm: the only change is the introduction of the highly plausible (37f) impoverishment rule. Thus, we can conclude that the empirical reach of Bárány's system (originally devised for the finite realm), with a few natural revisions and additions, covers the infinitival facts too.

8. Conclusion

In this paper, we analyzed the appearance of the 1>2SG suffix on the infinitival paradigm. We argued that the full gamut empirical facts can be accounted for by recourse to three competing grammars for agreeing infinitives: N (where infinitivals are nominal), $V_{deficient}$ (where infinitivals are verbal, with a paradigm gap in cell 1>2SG) and V_{full} (where infinitives are verbal, with no paradigm gap.) This results in there being two tribes of Modern Hungarian speakers: Tribe 1 (where N and $V_{deficient}$ compete very discreetly) and Tribe 2 (where V_{full} is crowding N out). Grammar N is in line with É. Kiss's (2002) proposal; whereas Grammars V can be plausibly modelled in moderately revised versions of Den Dikken's (2004) and Bárány's (2017) system (both of which were originally developed with the finite paradigm in mind). Finally, we have noted that the failure of the innovative paradigm (V_{full}) to spread fast and wide is probably due to three factors: (i) the relatively minor advantage offered by V_{full} to its alternatives, (ii) the fact that infinitival agreement in general is fading in the language and (iii) the spread of the Balkan subjunctive, which provides an established outlet for the verbalization of subordination.

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